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Section 4.2
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WaTech
Washington Technology Solutions

Customer Identity & Access Management
ENTERPRISE SERVICE STANDARD

See Also:
RCW 43.105.006 WaTech Purpose
RCW 43.105.020 Definitions
RCW 43.105.054 WaTech Governance
RCW 43.105.450 State agency information technology security

1. PURPOSE

This standard establishes the statewide service capability, Customer Identity & Access Management (CIAM), as an enterprise service under EA-02 – Establishing an Enterprise Service Policy. Customer Identity & Access Management uses appropriate authentication and identity verification methods based on the sensitivity of the information being accessed. It is intended to ensure consistent user experience, centralized identity management, and improved security across state government

This requirement covers new solutions and system upgrades that present an authentication experience to users. A Washington state agency must not adopt, build, expand, or renew a service with similar capabilities unless it has an approved waiver or exemption (see Section 5).

2. SCOPE

In Scope

The Customer Identity & Access Management Service capabilities must be used to find and authenticate access to state online services, websites, and applications managed by the state and serving public users.

Out of Scope

This standard does not apply to public interactions conducted directly with third-party vendors where agency staff do not have any access to the system and do not have any administrative or operational responsibilities. These vendors perform eligibility, application, payment, verification, assessment, or similar services and report the outcome to the agency.

3. APPLICABILITY

This standard applies to all state agencies (as defined in RCW 43.105.020). This standard does not apply to the K-20 network, institutions of higher education, legislature, judiciary, or local governments.

4. ENTERPRISE SERVICE CAPABILITIES

The Customer Identity & Access Management enterprise service designation encompasses the following capabilities:

1. Single Sign-On (SSO) solution for public users doing business with Washington state.
2. Multi-Factor Authentication (MFA) to validate that the user controls their identifiers (such as email address and phone number).
3. Identity Verification (IDV) confirms a user's identity and eligibility before granting access to services or sensitive information.

5. WAIVERS AND EXEMPTIONS TO THIS STANDARD

In accordance with POL-01-02-S Technology Policy and Standard Waiver Request Standard, agencies may qualify for a waiver or exemption from compliance with this standard. Agencies may request an exemption for situations that meet one of the following criteria.

1. Vendor-managed SaaS applications with limited scope and all of the following attributes:
    a. Do not support mission-critical or business-essential functions
    b. Do not integrate with any other systems
    c. Serve fewer than 10 users with no opportunity to grow beyond 25 users in the future
    d. Handle only Category 1 and/or Category 2 data
2. Temporary use or proof-of-concept (POC) applications with all of the following attributes:
    a. Duration of less than six months
    b. Non-production environment and data (this exemption will not carry over to production deployment)
3. Legal or Regulatory Systems (including federal or external systems requiring mandated credentials) that do not support Security Assertion Markup Language (SAML) or OpenID Connect (OIDC) integrations.
4. Multi-jurisdictional, regional, or community collaborations that require use of their own authentication.

6. AUTHORITY

This standard is issued under the authority of RCW 43.105.054, which grants WaTech authority to establish statewide technology standards and enterprise services. RCW 43.105.385 establishes WaTech as the central service provider for state agencies, supporting the delivery of common enterprise technology services. RCW 43.105.450 requires state agencies to comply with statewide information technology security policies and standards. Executive Order 25-06 establishes a comprehensive approach to improve customer

experience throughout state government, emphasizing accessibility, efficiency, effectiveness, security, simplicity, accountability, and customer satisfaction in government service delivery.

REFERENCES

1. Service Catalog Page: WA.gov Authentication
2. Definition of Terms Used in WaTech Policies and Reports
3. RCW 43.105.006 WaTech Purpose
4. RCW 43.105.054 WaTech Governance
5. RCW 43.105.450 State agency information technology security
6. SEC-08-01-S Data Classification Standard
7. NIST SP 800-63

CONTACT INFORMATION

For questions about this policy, please email the WaTech Policy Mailbox.